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AI IN MARKETING · by Adsmentor

FREE PROMPT GUIDE

RTCROS: the six-part prompt framework for marketers

Role, Task, Context, Rules, Output format, Style. Fill the six boxes before you press enter.

By Kailas Nath R. RTCROS is our own working checklist, not an industry standard. It covers the same ground as other frameworks, and the order of letters matters less than covering all six jobs.

> **The colleague test.** Anthropic's prompting guide suggests showing your prompt to a colleague with minimal context on the task. If they would be confused, the AI will be too.

The six parts

Part	Question it answers	Weak	Stronger
Role	Who should the AI act as?	(nothing)	You are a senior performance marketer who coaches beginners.
Task	What exactly is the job?	Help with my ad	Review the Meta ad below and find its three weakest points.
Context	What can it not guess?	(nothing)	Weekend yoga workshop, Pune, working women 28 to 40, goal 50 sign-ups.
Rules	What must it do, and never do?	(nothing)	Do not invent statistics. Flag any claim that could break ad policy.
Output format	What shape should the answer take?	Give me ideas	A table: issue, why it matters, one fix.
Style	How should it sound?	(nothing)	Plain English, warm, under 150 words, no jargon.

Your blank template

Role: You are a _____ (the kind of expert you would hire for this job).
Task: _____ (one verb and one deliverable, for example: draft three versions of...).
Context: business _____; audience _____; offer _____; goal and number _____; channel _____; what we tried before _____.
Rules: Use only the facts above. Do not invent numbers or testimonials. _____ (claims, banned words, limits). If something is missing, ask me before guessing.
Output format: _____ (table, numbered list, headline under __ characters, number of options).
Style: _____ (voice, reading level, language). Match this sample: _____.

Tips that work with any framework

- ☐ Paste real material (your best ad, last week's numbers) instead of describing it.
- ☐ Wrap pasted material in tags such as <data>...</data> so instructions and data do not mix.
- ☐ Show one or two examples of the voice or format you want.
- ☐ Split big jobs into steps and approve each step.

Four prompts you can copy today

Replace the brackets with your details. The yoga and ad examples are made-up briefs for teaching.

1. Review a Meta ad before it goes live

Role: You are a paid social reviewer who checks ads the way a strict client would.
Task: Review the ad copy below and list the three weakest points.
Context: [Business, audience, offer, goal, budget]. Ad copy: <ad>paste copy</ad>.
Rules: Do not rewrite the ad. Ask me one question per weak point. Flag any claim that could break Meta ad policy.
Output format: Table with columns: weak point, why it matters, question for me.
Style: Direct and kind, under 150 words.

2. Draft an SEO content brief

Role: You are an SEO editor who writes briefs for freelance writers.
Task: Create a content brief for a blog post targeting the phrase [keyword].
Context: Reader is [who]; site sells [what]; post should lead to [action]. Competitor headings: <competitors>paste</competitors>.
Rules: Do not invent statistics or studies. Suggest sections that answer real questions, not stuffing. Mark anything that needs a source.
Output format: Working title; search intent in one line; H2 outline; five FAQs; list of facts needing a source.
Style: Plain English a junior writer can follow.

3. WhatsApp follow-up for new leads

Role: You are a friendly CRM specialist for a small business.
Task: Draft a three-message WhatsApp follow-up for someone who enquired and has not replied.
Context: [Product or service]; enquiry source [source]; common question [question]. Send on day 1, day 3, day 7.
Rules: No pressure language. No discounts I have not approved. Each message gives one useful fact and one easy next step.
Output format: Three numbered messages, each under 50 words.
Style: Warm and conversational; English with simple Hindi words only if I ask.

4. Read your weekly numbers

Role: You are a marketing analyst who explains numbers to non-experts.
Task: Read the table and tell me what changed this week and what to check first.
Context: Goal is [goal]. Spend, clicks and leads for this week and last: <data>paste table</data>.
Rules: Use only the numbers provided. Separate what the data shows from what you are guessing. Suggest checks, not conclusions.
Output format: Three bullets on what changed, then a "check first" list of three items.
Style: Short sentences, no jargon.

Meta ads with an AI agent? The Rules part matters most when an AI tool can take actions. Read our Meta Ads MCP and CLI usage SOP at aiinmarketing.in/blogs/meta-ads-mcp-and-cli-sop.

RTCROS next to CO-STAR

CO-STAR is described by GovTech Singapore (tech.gov.sg, 3 April 2025): Context, Objective, Style, Tone, Audience, Response.

RTCROS	CO-STAR	Note
Role	(none)	RTCROS names who the AI is.
Task	Objective	Same job: say what you want.
Context	Context	Background the AI cannot guess.
Rules	(none)	RTCROS adds do and do-not fences.
Output format	Response	The shape of the answer.
Style	Style and Tone	CO-STAR splits voice in two.
(inside Context)	Audience	Add who the reader is to your Context line.

The ten-point check before you press enter

- ☐ Would a stranger understand the job?
- ☐ Did I name a role?
- ☐ Is the task one verb and one deliverable?
- ☐ Did I paste the real facts and numbers?
- ☐ Did I say what it must never do?
- ☐ Did I say "ask me if something is missing"?
- ☐ Did I choose the output format?
- ☐ Did I describe the voice or paste a sample?
- ☐ Is private data removed?
- ☐ Will I check every fact before publishing?

Fix the answer, then fix the prompt

Problem	Add this
Generic, could be anyone's ad	Context: real offer, audience, one example you like.
Invented numbers or claims	Rule: use only the facts above; mark anything unsupported.
Too long or messy	Output format: length limits and a table or list.
Wrong voice	Style: paste two samples and say "match this".
Tries to do too much	Task: split into steps and approve each.

My prompt log

Task	What I had to fix by hand	New rule or context line

Sources: Anthropic, Prompting best practices (platform.claude.com); GovTech Singapore, tech.gov.sg (3 April 2025). Test every prompt on your own data. Tools change quickly.